

EU Member State experience in cross-ministerial coordination and reporting under the Governance Regulation

Cross-Ministerial Coordination Session – Ukrainian Technical Visit

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European Environment Agency
European Topic Centre
Climate change mitigation



The European Topic Centre on Climate Change Mitigation (ETC CM)

- Support the European Environment Agency on the topics of greenhouse gas emissions, energy, and mobility.
 - Collecting, quality checking, compiling and reporting data and information;
 - Analysing and assessing this information;
 - Developing knowledge solutions to address environmental and sustainability challenges.
- <https://www.eionet.europa.eu/etcs/etc-cm>
- As part of the ETC activities, partners can be asked to contribute to specific additional requests from EEA.



EIONET ETC CM Publication

Strengthening National Governance Systems

Exploring Current Practices and Innovations for Reporting on
Policies and Measures and Greenhouse Gas Projections



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<https://www.eionet.europa.eu/etcs/etc-cm/products/etc-cm-report-2024-08>



Methodology



Methodology

What is the current state of play and the key challenges?



National system reports: Data collection framework to collect information on around 60 characteristics of national systems



Online survey: Questions addressing strengths and weaknesses, planned improvements, use of technology/ innovation, monitoring and evaluation practices: **12 / 30 responses**



3 interviews with national reporters from Ireland, Germany and Bulgaria: What challenges do countries face in reporting?

What good practices are already adopted by countries?



National system reports: Identification of good practices



Interviews with reporters and surveys: Detailed insights on practices that other countries can learn from

What opportunities are there to improve national systems?

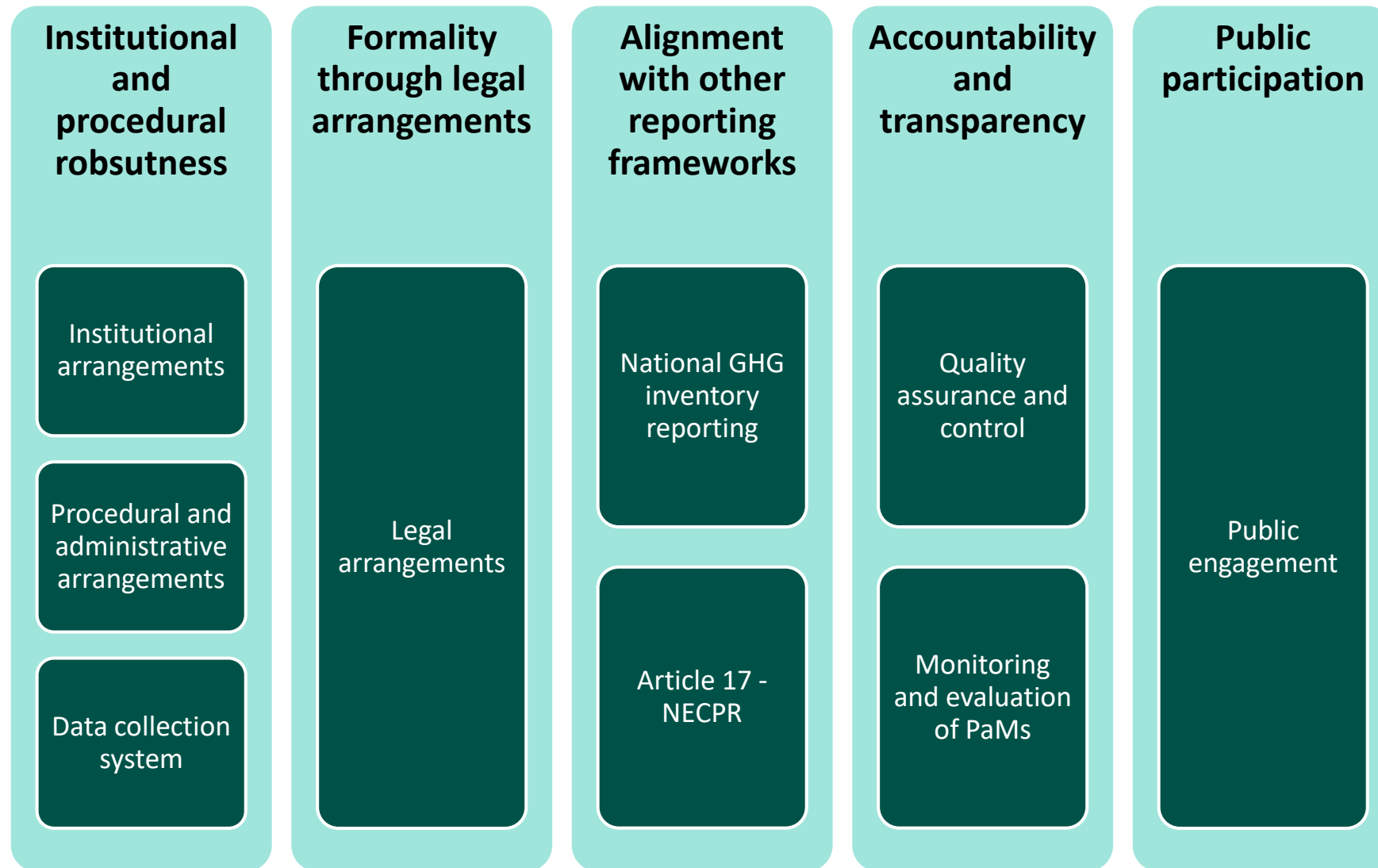


3 interviews with Claire Dupont and Louis Meuleman (EEA Scientific Committee), Matthias Duwe and Nick Evans (Ecologic Institute): Insights from a broader governance perspectives



Literature review: Future perspectives on innovative governance systems and reporting

The core elements of national systems



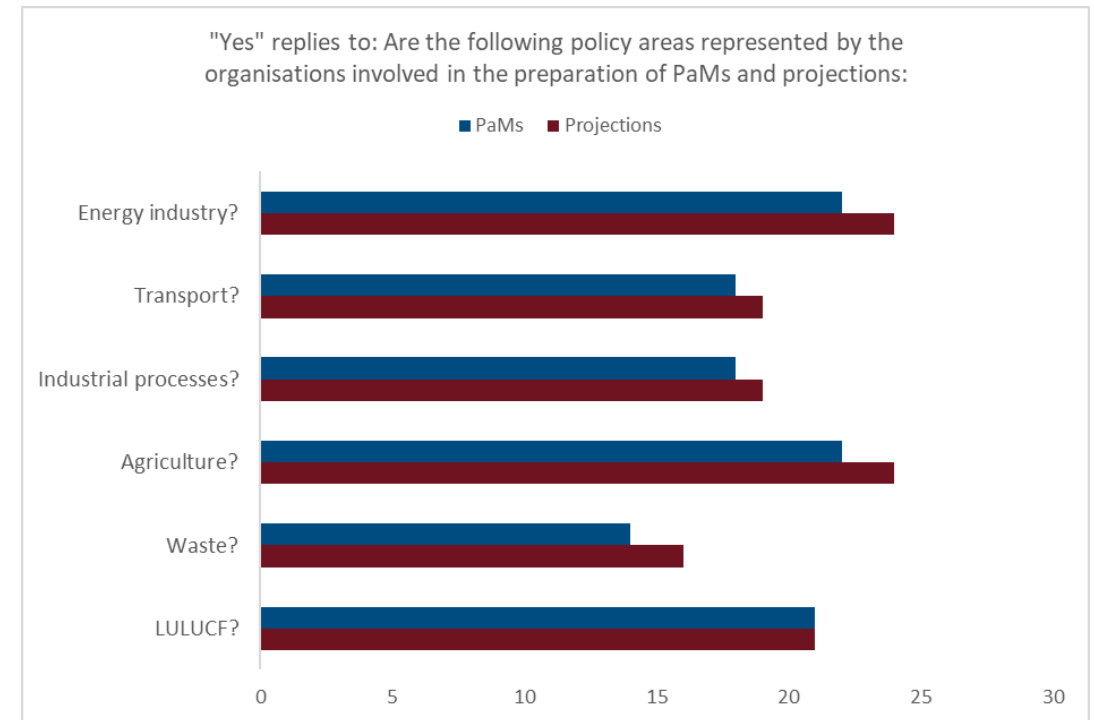
The key findings



Note: These results are based on the national systems reports submitted by countries under the Governance Regulation (EU) 2018/1999.

Institutional and procedural: Institutional arrangements

- In most countries, the **overall responsibility** for reporting is assigned to a single organisation.
- The relatively high level of **representation across sectors** suggests that institutional cooperation is well-established in most countries.
- Cooperation is further strengthened by formal networks. This occurs at the ministerial level (inter-ministerial working groups) and/or on the level of experts (intersectoral or technical working groups).



Institutional arrangements:

Ireland: independence of institutional arrangements

Croatia: Intersectoral committees/working groups

Iceland: involvement of local actors in inter-ministerial steering committee for Climate Action

Germany, the Netherlands: involvement of advisory body



Institutional and procedural: Procedural and administrative arrangements

Expert validation

Assumptions,
methodologies & models



Approving Reporting

High-level vs.
expert level



Review previous reporting

PaMs and projections



Approving National System

Mostly, same entity as
overall responsibility



Procedural and administrative arrangements:

Sweden, Latvia, Lithuania, Estonia, Ireland, Germany, and Cyprus: evaluation of reporting cycle



Institutional and procedural: Data collection

Arrangements in place for the collection and exchange of data/information between organisations

- Different styles can be found:
 - Hierarchical vs collaborative
 - Networking vs outsourcing
- Institutionalisation:
 - Formal arrangements (such as Memoranda of Understanding, or Service Level Agreements)
 - Special bodies or working groups

Data collection:

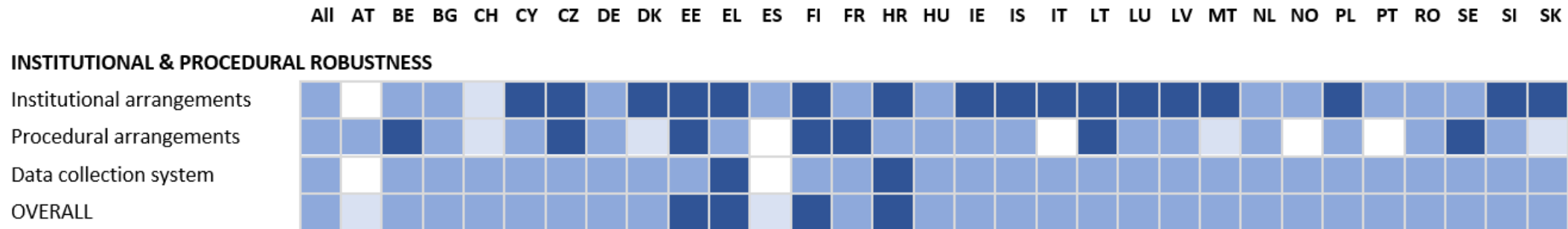
Bulgaria: Efforts to strengthen the inter-ministerial collaboration

Ireland, Latvia, Hungary: Data collection processes have a legal basis: e.g., Memorandum of Understanding, Service Level agreement, enshrined in regulation laying down the NS.

Netherlands: Climate Policy Dashboard used to report on progress but also facilitates data collection processes.



Many countries have well-established institutional and data collection arrangements for PaMs and GHG emission projections reporting.



State-of-play:

Most countries have:

- defined institutional responsibilities
- involvement of a diverse range of policy areas and experts in the reporting process
- robust data collection procedures

Key Challenges:

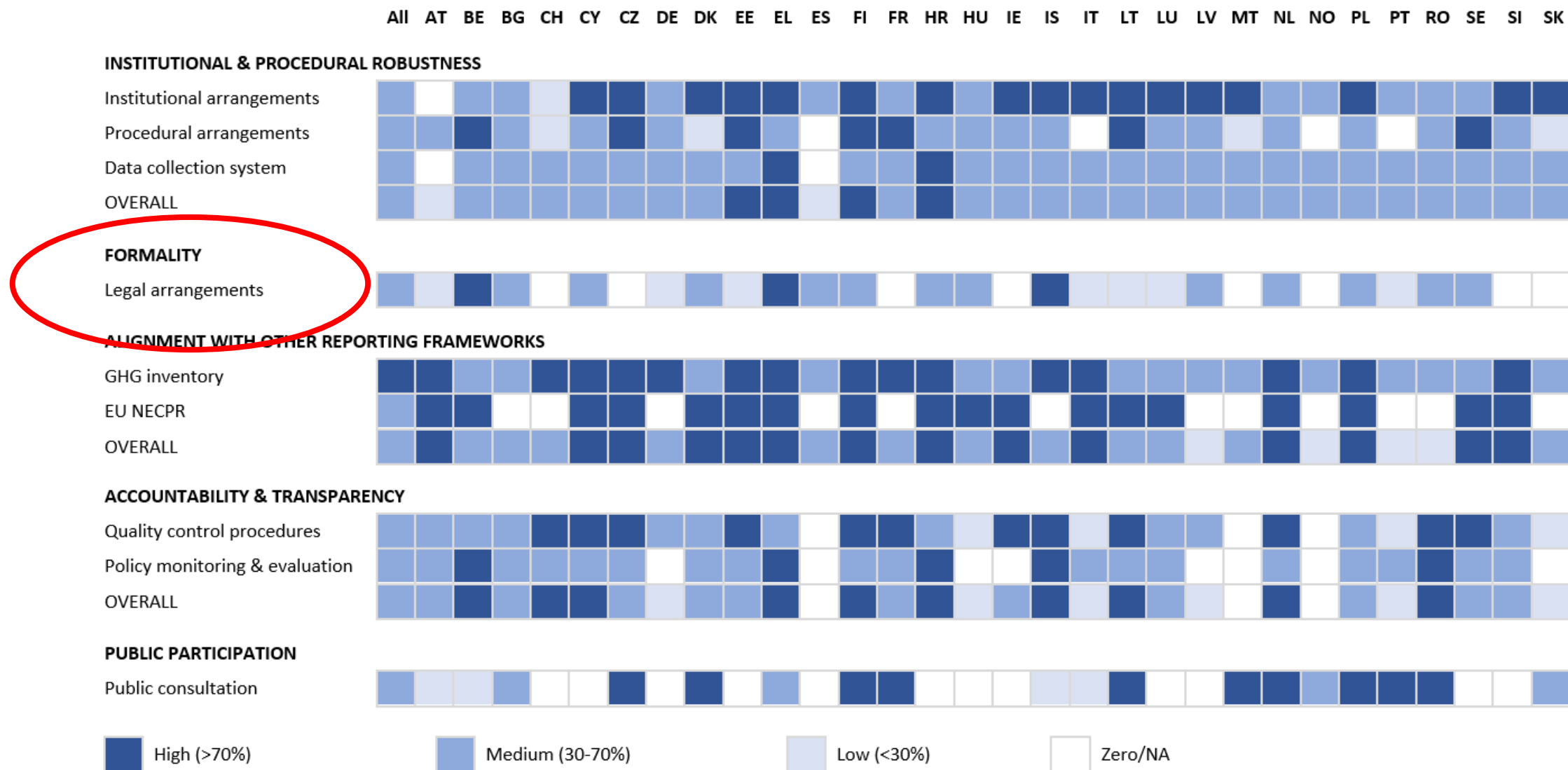
- Limited in-house capacity – reliance on outsourcing of reporting tasks
- Setting up robust inter-ministerial networks: delayed data provision, limited mechanisms for regular input
- Lack of coordination between PaMs and projections reporters
- Limited policy integration

What can countries do better:

- Strengthening the network of sectoral experts to enhance stakeholder input, and policy integration and consistency
- Advisory councils to increase transparency and accountability
- Peer review processes and multi-level dialogues in policy decisions

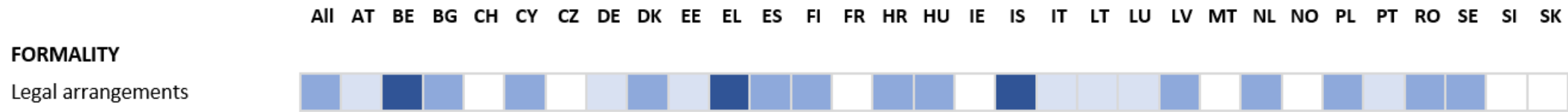


The key findings



Note: These results are based on the national systems reports submitted by countries under the Governance Regulation (EU) 2018/1999.

Countries with no legal arrangements could benefit from formalising their national systems to enhance long-term accountability of reporting practices.



State-of-play:

- Many countries have some form of legal arrangements for the national systems, but the aspects covered vary significantly between countries

Key Challenges:

- Lack of legal frameworks for national systems could have an impact on accountability in the reporting process

What can countries do better:

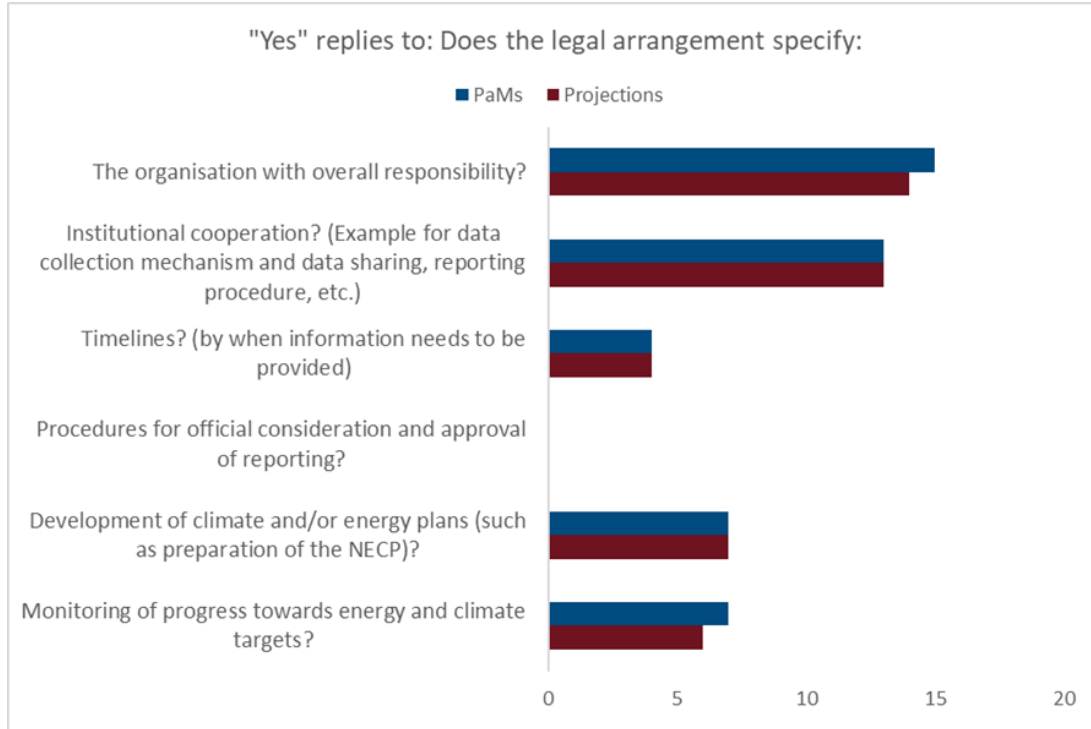
- Formalise national systems:
 - to facilitate inter-ministerial collaboration
 - enhance data exchange
 - improve the timeliness of reporting

Good practices:

Germany, the Netherlands, and Finland: Legal basis for progress reporting to Parliament



Formality through legal arrangements



Institutional aspects

- Overall responsibility: 15/30
- Cooperation: 13/30

Procedural aspects

- Timeline: 4/30
- Official consideration: 0/30

Planning and monitoring

- Link to other plans: 7/30
- Monitoring of targets: 7/30

Legal requirements for specific sectors (LULUCF and ETS)

Improvements indicated better alignment with Paris Agreement, Fit-for-55, or 'climate laws' in general.

Good practices:

Germany, the Netherlands, and Finland: Legal basis for progress reporting to Parliament



High-level recommendations

1. Robust governance systems enhance climate and energy reporting and policy alignment.
2. Many countries have well-established institutional and data collection arrangements for PaMs and GHG emission projections reporting.
3. Capacity and resource constraints undermine the effectiveness of national reporting systems.
4. Strengthening the network of sectoral experts is essential to enhance stakeholder input, and policy integration and consistency.
5. Procedures for the consideration, approval, and review of reporting and national systems are insufficient in many countries.



High-level recommendations

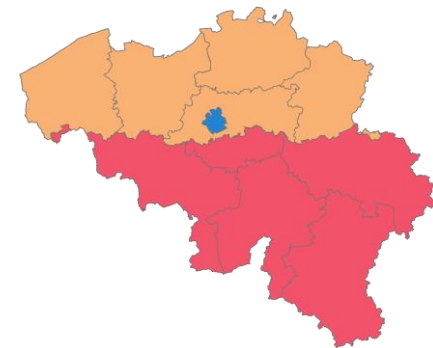
6. Countries with no legal arrangements could benefit from formalising their national systems to enhance long-term accountability of reporting practices.
7. PaMs and emission projections reporting is highly aligned with the GHG inventory and the EU NECPR. However, the reporting on these elements in the national system could be improved by several countries.
8. While quality control procedures are relatively extensive in many countries, there are still deficiencies in the quality of PaMs and emission projections reporting.
9. Policy monitoring and evaluation practices are still not sufficient in most countries for complete reporting on PaMs impacts.
10. Public consultation practices in climate policymaking and reporting vary widely, with some countries demonstrating strong stakeholder involvement while others have little or no involvement.





National system of Belgium

- *Belgium is a parliamentary constitutional monarchy with a complex federal system structured on regional and linguistic grounds* (Wikipedia)
- Competences such as greenhouse gas emissions and energy are the responsibility of the regions (Flanders, Wallonia, and Brussels Capital Region).
- For energy: Federal level responsible for security of supply; nuclear energy; offshore energy; large production, storage and transport infrastructure; and tariffs.
- This requires a coordination mechanism between the federal level and regional levels
- National Climate Commission (climate change): cooperation agreements on topics such as the National Climate Plan (2002), burden sharing (2015), ETS (2013), ...



National system of Belgium

- ENOVER (energy): established in the cooperation agreement of 1991.
- Constituents: 4 administrations (e.g. VEKA), 4 cabinets, Permanent Representative Belgium in EU, and FPS Foreign Affairs - DGE European Affairs and Coordination.
- Monthly coordination meetings:
 - Ensuring coherence of national and regional policies;
 - Aligning policies in response to EU legislation;
 - Collecting information for international reporting and the national energy balance;
 - Coordinating Belgian representation and national positions for international and European Institutions.
- Preparation in technical working groups focusing on energy (e.g. energy balance) and energy-related topics (e.g. NECP).



National system of Belgium

- In preparation of the Belgian National Energy and Climate Plan (NECP), a specific ENOVER-NCC steering committee 'NECP2030' was established to coordinate and steer the NECP.
- CONCERE/ENOVER-NCC steering committee NECP2030 also mandated to coordinate integrated NECP progress reports.
- Impact on reporting:
 - Quantitative data aggregated at the national level.
 - Reporting of textual information for federal and/or regional levels separately.

Annex II – Table 8: The **Federal government** did support the deployment of offshore wind production through different support mechanisms. [...]. The **Brussels Capital Region** supports the production of renewable electricity via green certificates. [...]. The **Flemish Region** calculates the appropriate support for each technology and gradually phases out the support as regular evaluations show that this is possible. [...]. The **Walloon Region** a study is ongoing.



Thank you

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